

ROBERTO PIRES ALMEIDA

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Portfolio: synckser.github.io/roberto-portfolio · GitHub: github.com/synckser · LinkedIn
British, Italian and Brazilian citizen (Full right to work in the UK, E.U and Brazil) · Full UK driving licence and own car

PROFILE

Second-year BSc Computer Science student at the University of London (Goldsmiths), with an 83% average across completed modules (first-class level), holding the Google IT Support and Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificates and building real software as an independent iOS app developer. I am passionate about artificial intelligence. I use AI tools every day to build apps, automate workflows and speed up my learning, I integrate AI APIs into my own software, and I am working towards the Machine Learning and AI specialism of my degree. Years of hands-on computer building, Mac repair and hardware troubleshooting, together with over ten years of public-sector work using case-management systems, complex data and demanding customers, have given me strong diagnostic, documentation and communication skills. I am now seeking an IT role in support, applications or junior development, where my passion for technology and calm, user-focused approach will add immediate value. My studies are part-time by distance learning and will not affect working hours.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **AI & machine learning:** daily hands-on use of AI assistants and AI pair-programming and coding agents to plan, build, review and test software; prompt engineering; integrating AI APIs (Anthropic Claude, Google Gemini, ElevenLabs speech and audio) into applications; running AI models on local hardware; studying towards the ML and AI degree specialism
- **Programming:** Python, SQL, Swift (iOS), JavaScript (p5.js, HTML5 canvas); Git and GitHub version control
- **Systems & networking:** Windows, macOS and Linux command line (including Kali Linux); TCP/IP networking fundamentals; system administration and IT infrastructure services
- **Hardware:** PC and Mac assembly, diagnostics, repair and upgrades, including GPU replacement, board-level microsoldering, SSD and RAM upgrades, OS rebuilds and system validation
- **Cybersecurity:** SIEM tools, Intrusion Detection Systems (IDS), risk and vulnerability assessment, incident detection and response, security automation with Python
- **Business applications:** Orchard housing management system, HomeLink choice-based lettings, Microsoft 365 (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Teams, Outlook)
- **Developer tools:** Xcode, VS Code, App Store Connect, GitHub Pages, REST APIs, scripting and workflow automation

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

BSc Computer Science, University of London (Goldsmiths), part-time by distance learning — **2025 to present**

- Second year, with an 83% average across completed modules, on track for a first-class degree: Computational Mathematics (89%), Introduction to Programming I (83.75%), Introduction to Programming II (78%), How Computers Work (credit via recognition of prior learning)
- Currently studying Discrete Mathematics; planned specialism in Machine Learning and Artificial Intelligence

Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate, Google / Coursera — **June 2026**

- Nine-course programme: security foundations, network security, Linux and SQL, assets, threats and vulnerabilities, detection and response, and automating security tasks with Python

Google IT Support Professional Certificate, Google / Coursera — **June 2026**

- Six-course programme: technical support fundamentals, computer networking, operating systems, system administration and IT infrastructure, and IT security

NVQ Level 3 Health and Social Care (QCF), 2019 · Police Learning and Deployment Programme, 2019 · Trinity College London English Level 2, 2010 · A-Levels: Maths, English, Portuguese, History, Physics, Chemistry, Biology, Sociology and Geography, 2001

PROJECTS & PORTFOLIO

Draw & Learn (iOS app), independent developer — **2026 to present**

- Designed and built a children's educational drawing and learning app in Swift, taking it through the full App Store submission process including metadata, localisation into multiple languages and screenshot preparation
- Integrated AI throughout the product: AI-generated speech and sound effects for the app's mascot via the Gemini and ElevenLabs APIs, AI-assisted asset creation, and Python automation pipelines for asset processing, audio generation and App Store screenshots (case study)

Hardware maintenance & Mac repair, personal practice over many years — **ongoing**

- Replaced a defective 2012 27-inch iMac GPU with a Metal-capable custom-firmware Nvidia card; recovered MacBook Pros with faulty discrete graphics using software methods and micro-soldered board-level fixes (custom CMIzapper Tiresias board)
- SSD, RAM and internal upgrades, OS rebuilds and retrofits, Linux installs (including Kali) and full boot and OS validation before returning machines to use (photos on my portfolio)

Interactive data visualisation app, university coursework, JavaScript (p5.js) — **live demo online**

- Built seven interactive charts, three designed from scratch, including an animated pie chart of ONS population data, a waffle chart of my own Google Forms survey and a staggered bar chart with easing; added hover tooltips, sound feedback and play/pause controls. Try it: synckser.github.io/data-vis

2D platform game, university coursework, JavaScript (p5.js) — **live demo online**

- Complete, polished game with gravity and jump physics, enemy patrol AI, collision detection, factory-style object creation, moving platforms, a boss chase, parallax scenery, sound and music, plus scoring, lives and restart logic. Try it: synckser.github.io/game-final

AI-powered tooling and automation, personal projects — **ongoing**

- Use AI coding agents as a core part of my development workflow for planning, generating, reviewing and testing code; build macOS utilities that automate document-processing workflows; keep pace with the AI field by evaluating new models, APIs and local AI setups

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Housing Adviser, Cambridge City Council — **Apr 2024 to present**

- Manage a complex statutory caseload under the Homelessness Reduction Act 2017, carrying out assessments, making formal legal decisions and issuing statutory decision letters
- Daily power user of the Orchard housing management system and HomeLink lettings platform: maintaining accurate records, producing correspondence and monitoring performance data
- Explain complex legal and procedural information clearly to people in crisis, face to face, by phone and in writing, and resolve problems calmly under pressure
- Collaborate with internal teams and external partners (Social Care, DWP, police, probation, legal services, landlords) to deliver coordinated outcomes

Tenancy Support Worker, P3 Charity — **Jan 2020 to Apr 2024**

- Supported vulnerable tenants with benefits claims, rent arrears, budgeting and housing applications, working across multiple digital platforms and online government services
- Received a company award for improving remote team working during the pandemic by introducing conference calls, translation apps and online file sharing that cut travel and improved collaboration
- Worked from home from 2020 onwards, independently managing and prioritising a full caseload using shared calendars and Microsoft Teams

Police Officer, Cambridgeshire Constabulary **Mar 2019 to Sep 2019**

- Responded to emergencies, managed conflict and made difficult decisions under pressure in line with law and procedure; trained in intelligence, evidence handling, statements and safeguarding

Earlier career in care and customer service **2010 to 2019**

- Senior Support Worker and first-line manager, Cambridgeshire County Council (2014 to 2019), supervising a team of support workers; Care Consultant, Medacs Healthcare, managing recruitment, rotas and payroll (2014); Healthcare Assistant, Bluebird Care (2014); Senior Waiter, Frankie & Benny's (2010 to 2014)

LANGUAGES & PERSONAL STRENGTHS

English (fluent) · Portuguese (fluent) · Italian (basic)

Reliable, self-motivated and resilient; a creative problem-solver who likes doing things differently and better; calm under pressure with strong conflict de-escalation skills; works well independently or in a team, connecting people, places and partnerships.